Sonde

Accessibility Health Check

https://nyc.gov

970

Excellent

April 9, 2026
Provided free by Sonde

https://daylight.sonde.life/section508/nyc-gov/

13 pages | **39** findings | **6** critical | **6** high | **23** medium | **4** low | **3.0** avg/page | **7,769** elements | **62** with findings | **99.2%** ECR | **5m 22s** total | **24.8s** per page

Top Findings

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.00:1 (required: 4.5:1 for normal text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(255, 255, 255). Text: "What's happening?"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<span class="small-paragraph">What's happening?</span>
```

1.00:1 ✗ CURRENT

4.54:1 ✓ SUGGESTED



#ffffff on #ffffff

#767676 on #ffffff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.00:1 (need 4.5:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #767676 (ratio: 4.5:1).

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.14:1 (required: 3:1 for large text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(226, 243, 255). Text: "Find what you need on nyc.gov"

WCAG 1.4.3

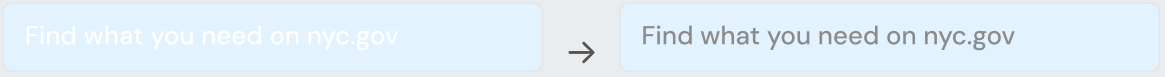
Page: /main WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<span class="main-heading--subhead">Find what you need on nyc.gov</span>
```

1.14:1 ✗ CURRENT

3.00:1 ✓ SUGGESTED



#ffffff on #e2f3ff

#8b8b8b on #e2f3ff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.14:1 (need 3:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #8b8b8b (ratio: 3.0:1). Or change background from #e2f3ff to #ffffff.

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.00:1 (required: 3:1 for large text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(255, 255, 255). Text: "Child care map"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<span class="cmp-accordion__title">Child care map</span>
```

1.00:1 ✗ CURRENT

#ffffff on #ffffff

→

3.03:1 ✓ SUGGESTED

Child care map

#949494 on #ffffff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.00:1 (need 3:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #949494 (ratio: 3.0:1).

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.00:1 (required: 4.5:1 for normal text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(255, 255, 255). Text: "Posted April 6, 2026"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<p class="cmp-teaser__pretitle">Posted April 6, 2026</p>
```

1.00:1 ✗ CURRENT

#ffffff on #ffffff

→

4.54:1 ✓ SUGGESTED

Posted April 6, 2026

#767676 on #ffffff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.00:1 (need 4.5:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #767676 (ratio: 4.5:1).

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.00:1 (required: 4.5:1 for normal text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(255, 255, 255). Text: "Find licensed child care providers in NYC and filter by dist"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<p>Find licensed child care providers in NYC and filter by distance, cost, facility type, and more.</p>
```

1.00:1 ✗ CURRENT

#ffffff on #ffffff

4.54:1 ✓ SUGGESTED

Find licensed child care provi...

#767676 on #ffffff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.00:1 (need 4.5:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #767676 (ratio: 4.5:1).

CRITICAL

Insufficient color contrast: 1.00:1 (required: 3:1 for large text). Foreground: rgb(255, 255, 255), background: rgb(255, 255, 255). Text: "Welcome to the Mayor's Office"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /mayors-office WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<h1 class="nyc-hero__title" data-heading-only="true" data-has-bread="false">
            Welcome to the Mayor’s Office
          </h1>
```

1.00:1 ✗ CURRENT

#ffffff on #ffffff

3.03:1 ✓ SUGGESTED

Welcome to the Mayor’s Office

#949494 on #ffffff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 1.00:1 (need 3:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #949494 (ratio: 3.0:1).

HIGH

Image has no accessible name in the accessibility tree. Screen readers will skip or announce it generically.

13 pages WCAG 1.1.1

Pages (13): /main, /mayors-office, /mayors-office/config, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15, /mayors-office/news/

WCAG 1.1.1

Element:

```
<!-- a11y: role="image" -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add alt text to the image. If decorative, mark with role="presentation" or alt="". WCAG 1.1.1 requires text alternatives for non-text content.

HIGH

Insufficient color contrast: 2.85:1 (required: 3:1 for large text). Foreground: rgba(0, 0, 0, 0), background: rgb(108, 149, 255). Text: "English"

WCAG 1.4.3

Page: /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1 WCAG 1.4.3

Element:

```
<span class="cmp-language-navigation__action-button--language" aria-hidden="true">English</span>
```

2.85:1 ✗ CURRENT

English

#ffffff on #6c95ff

3.02:1 ✓ SUGGESTED

English

#4c4c4c on #6c95ff

SONDE FIX PLAN

Current ratio: 2.85:1 (need 3:1). Change foreground from #ffffff to #4c4c4c (ratio: 3.0:1).

HIGH Focus jumps backward from "Spring Book Swap and Upcycled Paper Crafts with New York Pub" to "Learn to Swim Seward Park Class A" (visual distance: 644px). No explicit tabIndex — likely a DOM order issue. WCAG 2.4.3

Page: /main WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<a>Learn to Swim Seward Park Class A</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Reorder elements in the DOM to match the visual layout.

HIGH Focus jumps backward from "Privacy Policy" to "Terms of Service" (visual distance: 447px). No explicit tabIndex — likely a DOM order issue. WCAG 2.4.3

Page: /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<a>Terms of Service</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Reorder elements in the DOM to match the visual layout.

HIGH Missing Content-Security-Policy header 12 pages

Pages (12): /main, /mayors-office, /mayors-office/config, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15, /mayors-office/news/

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a Content-Security-Policy header with appropriate directives Add Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin or no-referrer

HIGH Missing Strict-Transport-Security header (HSTS)

Page: /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add Strict-Transport-Security header with max-age of at least 31536000 Add X-Frame-Options: DENY or SAMEORIGIN Add Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin or no-referrer

MEDIUM

Page has 2 "navigation" landmarks but only 1 have distinct labels. Screen reader users cannot distinguish between them.

2 pages WCAG 1.3.1

Pages (2): /main, /mayors-office/config WCAG 1.3.1

Element:

```
<!-- 2 navigation landmarks, 1 labeled -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add unique aria-label or aria-labelledby to each "navigation" landmark so screen readers can differentiate them. Example: <nav aria-label="Primary">, <nav aria-label="Footer">.

MEDIUM

Page has 4 "navigation" landmarks but only 1 have distinct labels. Screen reader users cannot distinguish between them.

4 pages WCAG 1.3.1

Pages (4): /mayors-office, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/

WCAG 1.3.1

Element:

```
<!-- 4 navigation landmarks, 1 labeled -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add unique aria-label or aria-labelledby to each "navigation" landmark so screen readers can differentiate them. Example: <nav aria-label="Primary">, <nav aria-label="Footer">.

MEDIUM

Page has 5 "navigation" landmarks but only 2 have distinct labels. Screen reader users cannot distinguish between them.

7 pages WCAG 1.3.1

Pages (7): /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15

WCAG 1.3.1

Element:

```
<!-- 5 navigation landmarks, 2 labeled -->
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add unique aria-label or aria-labelledby to each "navigation" landmark so screen readers can differentiate them. Example: <nav aria-label="Primary">, <nav aria-label="Footer">.

MEDIUM

Heading levels should only increase by one: Fix any of the following: Heading order invalid

13 pages

Pages (13): /main, /mayors-office, /mayors-office/config, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15, /mayors-office/news/

Element:

```
<h3><span>Thursday,</span><span>April 9, 2026</span></h3>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure the order of headings is semantically correct. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

Landmarks should have a unique role or role/label/title (i.e. accessible name) combination: Fix any of the following: The landmark must have a unique aria-label, aria-labelledby, or title to make landmarks distinguishable

11 pages

Pages (11): /mayors-office, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15, /mayors-office/news/

Element:

```
<nav id="primary-navigation" class="cmp-navigation">
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Ensure landmarks are unique. See: https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/quickref/

MEDIUM

Link is distinguished from surrounding text only by color (link: rgb(5, 26, 219), text: rgb(0, 0, 0)). Users who cannot perceive color differences may not identify this as a link.

WCAG 1.4.1

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.1

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.nyc.gov/assets/dsny/forms/collection-schedule"><u>Check your collection schedule</u></a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a non-color visual indicator to links: underline (text-decoration: underline), border-bottom, increased font-weight, or a visible icon. The indicator must be present in the default state, not just on hover.

MEDIUM

"Website feedback" is visually at position 12 but receives focus at position 20 (drift: 8).

WCAG 2.4.3

Page: /mayors-office/config WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<a>Website feedback</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Align DOM order with visual presentation, or use tabIndex to match the visual sequence.

MEDIUM "Your government" is visually at position 22 but receives focus at position 14 (drift: 8). WCAG 2.4.3

Page: /mayors-office/config WCAG 2.4.3

Element:

```
<a>Your government</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN
Align DOM order with visual presentation, or use tabIndex to match the visual sequence.

MEDIUM Broken link: https://www.nyc.gov/mayors-office/config#mainContent returns 404 Not Found

Page: /mayors-office/config

Element:

```
<a href="https://www.nyc.gov/mayors-office/config#mainContent">Skip to main content
</a>
```

MEDIUM Page has only one navigation mechanism (navigation). WCAG requires at least two ways to locate a page within a set of pages. 6 pages WCAG 2.4.5

Pages (6): /main, /mayors-office, /mayors-office/config, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/

WCAG 2.4.5

SONDE FIX PLAN
Add at least two of: site navigation (<nav>), search functionality (input[type="search"] or role="search"), a sitemap link, breadcrumb navigation, or a table of contents.

MEDIUM Content clipped by 27px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability. 2 pages WCAG 1.4.12

Pages (2): /main, /mayors-office/news/ WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<span class="carousel-annoucer sr-only" aria-atomic="true" aria-live="polite">showin
g slide 5 of 5</span>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 249px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<li class="carousel-slide " data-si="5"><div class="carousel-slide-content"><div cla
ss="carousel-slide-content--desc"><div class="teaser cmp-teaser--event  labelled"><d
iv class="cmp-teaser__content"><
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 214px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<h3 class="cmp-teaser__title"><a href="/main/events?permalinkName=nature-sketching&a
mp;id=920096&amp;sequence=1">Nature Sketching</a></h3>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 234px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<div class="teaser cmp-teaser--event  labelled"><div class="cmp-teaser__content"><di
v class="cmp-teaser__desc"><div><h3 class="cmp-teaser__title"><a href="/main/events?
permalinkName=nature-sketching&a
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 168px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<a href="/main/events?permalinkName=nature-sketching&amp;id=920096&amp;sequence=1">N
ature Sketching</a>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 150px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /main WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<p>Photo by David Benyukhis</p>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Content clipped by 61px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability. 2 pages WCAG 1.4.12

Pages (2): /main, /mayors-office WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<span id="carousel-title-QcPwx6LOoj" class="carousel-title sr-only" aria-hidden="tru
e">Latest News</span>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM Element overflows viewport by 186px at 320px width. WCAG 1.4.10

Page: /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor WCAG 1.4.10

Element:

```
<iframe title="reCAPTCHA" width="256" height="60" role="presentation" name="a-jxxi63
ltkjwp" frameborder="0" scrolling="no" sandbox="allow-forms allow-popups allow-same-
origin allow-scripts allow-top-n
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Set max-width: 100% or use overflow-wrap to prevent horizontal overflow.

MEDIUM Content clipped by 7px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability. WCAG 1.4.12

Page: /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<div class="grecaptcha-badge" data-style="bottomright" style="width: 256px; height:
60px; display: block; transition: right 0.3s; position: fixed; bottom: 14px; right:
-186px; box-shadow: gray 0px 0px
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM

Content clipped by 134px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability.

WCAG 1.4.12

Page: /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<span class="cmp-link__screen-reader-only">opens in a new tab</span>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM

Content clipped by 25px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability.

WCAG 1.4.12

Page: /mayors-office/news/ WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<span id="filter-header-GGp8p68DKx">News filter control</span>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM

Content clipped by 42px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability.

WCAG 1.4.12

Page: /mayors-office/news/ WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<span class="sr-only">NYC</span>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

MEDIUM Content clipped by 114px when text spacing is applied per WCAG 1.4.12. Text may be hidden when users adjust spacing for readability. WCAG 1.4.12

Page: /mayors-office/news/ WCAG 1.4.12

Element:

```
<div class="modal__pane">
      <div class="modal__header">
        <div class="modal__header-content">
          <button type="button" class="modal__close-button" data-close-modal="" aria
-controls="g
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Avoid fixed-height containers with overflow: hidden for text content. Use min-height or allow containers to grow.

LOW Deep focus region: navigation "Footer" has 15 tab stops before focus escapes. Consider adding skip navigation or grouping with arrow keys. WCAG 2.4.1

Page: /mayors-office/news/ WCAG 2.4.1

Element:

```
<div role="navigation">Footer</div>
```

SONDE FIX PLAN

Add a "skip to content" link or use roving tabindex to reduce the number of Tab stops.

LOW Broken link: https://new.mta.info/ returns 403 Forbidden

Page: /main

Element:

```
<a href="https://new.mta.info/">Check transit alerts</a>
```

LOW Broken link: http://www.twitter.com/nycmayorsoffice returns 520 <none> 11 pages

Pages (11): /mayors-office, /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor, /mayors-office/mayors-office-accessibility, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-1, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-10, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-11, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-12, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-13, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-14, /mayors-office/news/2022/01/emergency-executive-order-15, /mayors-office/news/

Element:

```
<a href="http://www.twitter.com/nycmayorsoffice"></a>
```

LOW Broken link: https://a860-openrecords.nyc.gov/ returns 403 Forbidden

Page: /mayors-office/contact-the-mayor

Element:

```
<a href="https://a860-openrecords.nyc.gov/">Freedom of Information Law (FOIL) tracke
r</a>
```

Methodology

The Sonde Score is a universal 0–1000 compliance index — think of it like a credit score for accessibility. Each finding is weighted by its impact on human access: a keyboard trap (critical) counts far more than a best-practice suggestion (low). The raw penalty is normalized per page so scores are comparable across sites of any size. A harmonic curve ensures every site gets a meaningful score — no zeros, no false perfection.

```
Score = round(1000 × S / (S + P/N))
```

where S = sensitivity (750), P = Σ(weight × count), N = pages scanned

TIER	WEIGHT	EXAMPLES
Critical	10	Keyboard traps, missing page language
High	3	Missing alt text, insufficient contrast
Medium	1	Heading hierarchy, unclear link purpose
Low	0.25	Best-practice suggestions

The Sonde Score is a living standard (v0.1). We're building it in the open because accessibility is too important for closed-door decisions. Your expertise makes it better.

This report is a health check, not a verdict. Every website has room to improve.

Disclaimer: This report presents the results of automated accessibility analysis and is provided free of charge, as-is, without warranty of any kind. Findings are generated by software, not by human accessibility experts, and may contain errors or omissions. Scores reflect algorithmic analysis under a published methodology open to public review—they are not legal determinations of compliance. Nothing in this report constitutes legal advice. Sonde assumes no liability for decisions made based on these results.

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